UAply: Marketing and Fundraising Session

October 13, 2026. Summary of what was researched, built and decided.

Goal

Reach 200-300 users in two weeks, then use that traction to pursue funding. UAply is for everybody: students, interns, call center workers, career changers, anyone job hunting.

Research findings

- **Getting users:** career centers and clubs convert best, then QR flyers at libraries and student centers. Expect about 1,000-2,500 real clicks for 300 users. Comparable student startups reached 150-200 users in 2-10 weeks (self-reported).
- **QR codes:** use dynamic codes with lowercase UTM tags, one per campus and spot, and count signups in the app.
- **Daily auto-posting:** not recommended. Reddit bans promotional bots and restricts commercial API use; Product Hunt and Kickstarter are single launches. Plan: draft daily, user submits Reddit and Product Hunt posts by hand; scheduling on the user's own social accounts is safe.
- **Kickstarter:** weak fit for a free web app. Fees about 5% plus 3-5% processing, charged only on success. Needs an audience before launch.
- **Ads:** AdSense is hard to get on a free subdomain and earns cents at 300 users. Paid employer listings or a premium tier are better later.

Philadelphia funding (verify each on the official page)

Source	Offer	Who
Penn Wharton Innovation Fund	$1,000 Design, $2,000 Build awards	Enrolled Penn students
Temple Be Your Own Boss Bowl	Reported $30K-$60K grand prize plus in-kind	Temple students, alumni, staff
Drexel Baiada Innovation Tournament	Four $5,000 awards, a year of incubation	Drexel students, alumni
Ben Franklin Road to LionCage	Six regional pitch events	All founders
Philadelphia Regional Startup World Cup	2026 round held Sept 18	Watch for 2027

Two-week schedule

- Days 1-2: landing page, signup counter, UTM scheme, QR codes, demo video.
- Days 3-4: email career centers and clubs; join campus Discords; help in Reddit threads.
- Days 5-7: flyers, tabling at two campuses, first soft posts.
- Days 8-10: follow up with clubs; prepare Product Hunt.
- Days 11-14: Product Hunt launch; write a traction summary.
- Day 15+: apply to competitions and grants.

Kickstarter

- Account and draft project exist in the user's Chrome. ID, bank details and Submit are the user's steps.
- Saved in the draft: title "UAply: job hunting for everyone, one swipe at a time" and subtitle "Swipe right to save a job and apply in one tap. For students, interns, career changers and anyone job hunting. Built in Philadelphia."
- Suggested goal $1,500 for 25 days; tiers $3, $12, $30, $150.
- Still empty: category (Technology), location, image or video, funding, rewards, story, people, payment. Story needs the user count, a tester quote and the budget split.

Files and pages

- Growth plan page: claude.ai/artifact/MJT1TweN7FZprG6pni2yUF
- Kickstarter draft page: claude.ai/artifact/2a7hcaeQkwgrAQgLLpc1nq
- Store cover page: claude.ai/artifact/VhL77fWPW5M1swqhENCate
- Repository folder marketing/ and pull request: github.com/saifsiddiqueep-sketch/uaply/pull/2

Open items

- Cover design: the new plum and pink icon was applied to the cover and exported images, but the latest message suggests this may not be wanted. Confirm whether to keep it, revert to teal, or use only the original icon file.
- Which school are you or a teammate enrolled in? Do you own a custom domain? Which social accounts to schedule posts on?
- Finish the Kickstarter editor sections and stop before Submit.